Swerve!

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/57782599.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by dfs (dead_frog)

Summary

Catra turns back to see them steering wonkily, their motorbike driving in a zigzag despite its speed. *A drunk biker who isn't paying attention to the traffic lights.*

It surges forward and straight past Catra and right towards Glimmer who's still crossing.

Time suddenly slows for Catra and the first thing that comes to her mind is; what would Adora do?

Catra braces as she revs her engine, speeding onto the road and *just* fast enough to shove Glimmer off the path of the motorbiker. Catra has to swerve to avoid hitting a car. It's too easy to lose balance.

Oh no.

-

After a stressful day involving Catra getting fired and Adora contacting her, Catra takes her motorbike out for a ride to relieve her anger. When Catra sees Glimmer about to be run over, Catra narrowly saves her and ends up hospitalised as a result.

Parallels to three She-Ra episodes : Corridors, Save the Cat and Taking control

Notes

just wanted to upload some writing :)

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra has been having a shit day.

First, her boss fired her because her services are *no longer needed.*

Second, *Adora* reached out.

Catra couldn’t tell you why Adora decided to reach out after a whole year. Adora, who was too prim and proper for the workplace and deemed it doing too much bad for society. Adora, who had seen Catra being slapped by their boss and saw it normal. Adora, who only saw it fit to leave when she realised the company was supporting evil corporations ~~but didn’t care they were hurting Catra~~.

Catra’s angry. She doesn’t want to think about this. She’s spent the last year reeling over Adora leaving, screaming at Adora whenever she tried to contact her and even slashing her. So Adora stopped trying to reach out. She stopped calling Catra, stopped going to Catra’s favourite spots and avoided Catra when she could.

Catra is~~not~~ okay with that. This is what she wants. She had spent ages trying to get through Adora’s thick skull that Catra doesn't want her, and Catra thought Adora finally understood that until yesterday.

Catra's ramped up and quite frankly *angry* that Adora reached out; mad that Adora disturbed the peaceful serenity of her life like a rock to a still pond.

Catra gets the keys to her motorbike and slides on her leather jacket. She *has* to clear her mind.

Her mind is telling her stupid things, like to apologise to Adora and to apologise for all the screaming and yelling and scratching and to just make peace.

Her mind is also telling her to find and scream at Adora. How conflicting

She turns the keys in her motorbike and revs the engine, relishing the way the bike buzzes under her. The engine grumbles and Catra lets out a steady exhale, sliding on her helmet and hi-vis jacket.

Because she may be angry but she's not unsafe.

Maybe a little though, when she speeds through the alleys with little concern for the speed limit. The wind is flush against Catra and she gets the feeling she's craving. The freedom of high speed.

She rids herself of her thoughts and turns onto a road, slowing down to the speed limit when she sees there are cars. Pulling up

to an intersection, Catra can see that on the other side a woman is crossing. Catra looks away, because the last thing she wants to see is that woman who is definitely one of Adora's friends; Sparkles, was it? Catra pretends not to remember the name that leaves a bitter taste in her mouth. Behind her, Catra can hear another motorbike revving its engine loudly and gaining speed. But the light is still red and Sparkles isn't off the road. The engine behind her doesn't settle, if anything it gets worse and louder. Catra turns back to see them steering wonkily, their motorbike driving in a zigzag despite its speed. *A drunk driver who isn't paying attention to the traffic lights*.

It surges forward and straight past Catra and right towards Glimmer who's still crossing.

Time suddenly slows for Catra and the first thing that comes to her mind is; what would Adora do?

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Oh no.

Catra's head crashes with the pavement as she goes skidding off her bike, tumbling across the road at what feels like record speeds. She lets out a loud yell as she comes to a stop, crying out. Her vision goes black for several moments. When it comes back it's blurry. Her eyes are wide when notices people crowding

around her. Her phone is in front of her face, its shattered screen glimmering in the street light. Catra reaches up for it with the hand she isn't on top of. Several people kneel down to her and ask her questions, but Catra's ignoring all of them. The phone unlocks itself at the sight of Catra's face, "Adora," Catra cries, trying to press the buttons on her phone to call Adora. Her words come out slurred and uneven. She can't feel her arm.

Someone takes the phone away from Catra and Catra hisses, the best she can despite the *pain*. Catra can see someone talking into *her* phone with a worried expression

Catra needs to get up, needs to grab her phone and needs to-

The person holding Catra's phone hovers it over Catra's ear,

"Catra?" Adora's worried voice fills her ear, "I'm on my way. The ambulance have been called,"

"I'm so sorry," Catra sobs, a shaky hand reaching up the hold the phone in her own grasp, "I'm so sorry for everything, Adora,"

"No, no, no Catra! It's okay!" Adora's voice is high and anxious,

"Glimmer's here too. Almost hit," Catra can't articulate her thoughts. They're scattered, and her heart doesn't feel like it's in her chest, "saved,"

“Wh- Catra I don't get it. What’s Glimmer doing there,”

“Never meant to hurt you,” Catra lets out another bone shattering sob, one that makes every inch of her ache even more than it already does, “get here, Glimmer’s here. I’m so sorry, don’t wanna be here,”

“Hey, hey, hey,” Adora says anxiously, “I’m gonna take you home,”

“Promise?” Catra’s voice has dropped into a strained whisper, barely audible but just loud enough to be heard,

“I promise!” Adora shouts. It’s too loud; Catra throws her phone away from her face and screams, the pain worse than anything before. There’s something wrong with her arm and her head is pounding. She can’t do this.

She’s vaguely aware of seeing Glimmer running over and holding her hand. The blaring ambulance alarms are ringing in her head and Catra isn’t sure if the ambulances are actually there or if they're in her head because the alarm is just *too* loud. She screams some more as people strap her into something. A gloved hand holds up her arm and Catra shrieks. As they go to close the ambulance doors, Catra hears a voice

Adora.

Then the doors to the ambulance close; and so do Catra’s eyes.

-

Catra feels like she has been drowning and is only now nearing the surface. Her eyes are hazy and she can’t focus on much but she blinks them open. When she finally starts processing her surroundings, it hits like a truck, a clamour of noises and light hitting her at once. Adora calling something… figures she can't quite make out looming over her… something cold entering her bloodstream. As it pulses around, Catra gasps and jolts, breath sporadic as her claws unsheath. She claws onto Adora to stabilise herself. “Adora!” Catra shrieks distortedly, her head pounding. She doesn’t even recognize her own voice.

“I’m right here,” Adora assures, but it’s a million miles away. Adora’s voice sounds distant and muffled. The cold feeling in her bloodstream returns once again and Catra realises she is being drugged.

“No… stop,” she cries, weakly tugging her arm away from where the nurse is injecting fluids into her IV. When did the nurse get there? When did her surroundings start to exist? The nurse tries to get closer but Catra hisses.

“Can you stop?” Adora pleads to the nurse, still cradling Catra despite the direct tone she spoke to the nurse with. Adora’s voice now is close, like it’s vibrating against Catra’s heart. No, too close.

“All done,” the nurse is not in the bubble of Catra’s mind; she can’t make out the words the nurse is saying.

“You’re just disorientated, give yourself time,” Adora whispers to Catra. Catra can’t grasp the idea of time when it feels like she is floating in space, watching her life on a screen.

“Adora,” Catra croaks out again. She can’t even recognize her own voice.

“I’m here.”

It takes hours before Catra feels her own body. She blinks around herself, taking in the bleak white and the fluorescent lights on the roof. Catra shifts and realises her arm is casted and her ribs are bruised. But she ignores it, just for a moment,

“Hey Adora,” Catra leans her head into Adora’s chest and her eyes flutter up to Adora’s face,

“You’re awake,” Adora whispers, almost in disbelief. She cradles the side of Catra’s face, holding her as though Catra could fall out of Adora’s arms, “you saved Glimmer,”

“I *shoved* her,” Catra rebutted,

“To get her out the way of a drunk biker,” Adora finishes. Catra can hear the confusion in Adora’s voice but she doesn't address it,

“Go,” Catra says, her voice blank. She can see the way Adora’s heart breaks; it’s written all over her face, “leave me alone,”

“I promised you that I’ll take you home,” Adora narrows her eyes. Catra scoffs,

“Then you can be my prestigious carriage that carries me home when I get discharged, but until then leave me alone,” Catra scowls. Adora frowns, but wordlessly shuffles out the bed. She hangs in the door frame, if only for a moment,

“Did you mean it when you said you were sorry?” Adora asks quietly. Catra is met with an uncomfortable decision; to tell the truth or to lie,

“We’ve always told each other truths at our weakest,” Catra mumbles back, turning away from Adora.

Adora feels the light flutter in her heart again, feels it pulsing around, “I forgive you,” It’s the only response that Adora can find before she walks away

-

When Adora returns to Catra's hospital room, she finds she just missed Catra's doctor, who is walking out the door as Adora walks in, "you again?" Catra scoffs,

"No one else is coming to visit you," Adora raises an eyebrow. Catra's eyebrows immediately furrow and she turns away from Adora, "what did your doctor want?" Adora tries, sitting on the end of Catra's bed,

"None of your business," Catra mutters. Adora lets out a long groan,

"Why are you acting so immature? You said you were sorry,"

"Just because I'm sorry doesn't mean I want to be friends again. So leave me alone!" Catra shouts. Adora is beyond hurt, her eyes watering before she gained her resolve,

"I'm such an idiot. I thought things were going to be different this time but clearly nothing has changed. You're still a stubborn brat," Adora spits,

"Oh yeah, I'm just an *insolent, disobedient pest*?" Catra mocks Shadow Weaver, their old boss. Adora pauses, crossing her arms,

“You know I didn’t mean it like that,” She says, then promptly leaves the room,

-

Adora still comes back a day later. Despite Catra’s annoyance, Adora seems to be persistent and optimistic. She sits in the corner and reads as Catra reads her own book in bed. Catra doesn't tell Adora to leave this time, she just accepts her presence, “Hi, Catra,” One of Catra’s doctors said, “we have new medicine for you. It’s critical we get this done soon-”

“No, I don’t want to. Just keep me on the pain meds,” Catra responds nonchalantly, not bothering to look up from her book. Adora’s eyes flicker up,

“Is it okay if she is in here whilst we discuss this?” The doctor asks, gesturing toward Adora,

“Sure,” Catra said bitterly, closing her book, “my answer still stays the same,” Adora's eyes are squaring on Catra,

“I’m sorry, what’s this medication?” Adora inquires,

“It’s a blood thinner. Catra’s at high risk for a blood clot that will cause a heart attack,” The doctor explains, “it has relatively low chances of any side effects and will be most effective,”

“Catra,” Adora groans, “why are you denying this?”

“How much does it cost without health insurance, all of this?” Catra asks the doctor, her eyes still trained on the book. Adora heart sinks and she speaks before the doctor can,

“You have health insurance. Horde Industries gives alright health insurance,” Adora frowns,

“I got fired, genius,” Catra scowls. Adora’s face drops, guilt plastering over her face, “aspirin is a blood thinner, right? Put me on some of that,” Catra frowns, crossing her arms,

“It conflicts with your stronger pain medication,” The doctor explains, “however the other medicine will be quite pricey without healthcare and you’ll have to pay out of pocket,” The doctor informs in a small, almost ashamed tone,

“Take me off the pain meds and put me on the aspirin then,” Catra mutters,

“Can I pay for the other medications?” Adora asks, already bringing out her wallet. Adora is loaded; her *new* job with *new*

people gave her *new* money whilst Catra rotted with the scraps. Catra snaps,

"You always have to be the hero, don't you!" She scoffs,

"I just want to help you!" Adora cries back

"I never asked for your help. Just let me go!"

"I promised I'd take you home and that's exactly what I'm gonna do. Why are you acting like this?"

"I know you hate me!" Catra yells,

"I never hated you!" Adora yells in response. The room goes dead quiet. Catra's *sure* she's suffocating. The air has turned to sand and now it scratches the inside of her throat and makes her choke. Adora feels the palms of her hands turn uncomfortably clammy,

"I'm going to give you some privacy," The doctor says, leaving the room,

"Catra, I'm *going* to pay for your medications so I can take you home. Then if you want me gone and you lash out at me I'll

leave, but not until I take you home," Adora's voice is strong and firm. All Adora is trying to do is reach Catra,

"Alright," Catra finally relents. Adora lets out a long exhale, relieved that Catra went along with the plan, "just… stay,"

-

"Why are you doing this?" Catra questions. There's been a steady stream of drugs entering her system but she's almost ready to go home. Adora's sitting on the end of the bed.

"You… you're *you*, I couldn't *not* do this," Adora explains, for lack of better words,

"When you take me home, is everything gonna go back to the way it was?" Catra whispers, eyes flickered down to the hospital's duvet,

"It doesn't have too," Adora smiles, leaning over to brush Catra's face with her fingertips. Catra lets her eyes shut as she embraces that touch,

"I love you," Catra says, knowing that Adora may not love her back but still vowing to be honest. It's the least she owes Adora,

“I love you too,”

End Notes

ok so if u have read paint me would you (another one of my fic) this also kiiiiinda happened idk why but writing car crashes is fun guys don't come at me!! surprisingly im close to finishing the final chapter of PMWY which is insane like it's been a year since I started it and now it's all wrapping up

i hope you leave comments and kudos, sorry if theres any mistakes this was just some fun writing for me i haven't really proofread it lmao

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!